

Actions

You can perform a number of operations on the marked files and directories. To copy a file, you can press *C* on a file, and it will prompt you in the minibuffer regarding where you would like to create the new copy. You can use *R* to rename a file. If you would like to delete a file, you can press *D*. You can change the mode of a file with the *M* command. You can compress or uncompress a file with the *Z* command.

A regular expression search can be done on selected files with the *A* command. You can create a symbolic link file with the *S* key. You can run a shell command on marked files using the *!* command. For example, if you want to perform a word count (*wc*) on the *date.txt* file, you can press *!* on the *date.txt* entry listing, “and it will prompt you in the minibuffer with the *!* on *date.txt*: message”. If you input *wc*, the results will again be shown in the minibuffer. On my system, it returned ‘1 6 29 *date.txt*’. You can also run asynchronous shell commands on files using the *&* command, and a new buffer will be opened that will contain the results.

Deletion

You can mark files for deletion using the *d* command. After selecting the files or directories, if you press *x*, the respective actions will be performed on the files. To demonstrate an example, let us use *d* on the *kernel* directory to mark it for deletion. The letter *D* will be added to its entry as shown below:

```
/tmp/test:
total used in directory 24 available 146933432
drwxrwxr-x 4 shakthi shakthi 4096 Jul 5 09:53 .
drwxrwxrwt 10 root root 4096 Jul 5 09:46 ..
-rw-rw-r-- 1 shakthi shakthi 29 Jul 5 09:46 date.txt
D drwxrwxr-x 2 shakthi shakthi 4096 Jul 5 09:46 kernel
-rw-rw-r-- 1 shakthi shakthi 270 Jul 5 09:46 locale.txt
drwxrwxr-x 2 shakthi shakthi 4096 Jul 5 09:46 network
```

When you press *x*, you will be prompted to confirm deletion with the message ‘Delete kernel (yes or no)’. When you input ‘Yes’ and hit the return key, the directory’s contents will be removed. GNU Emacs will perform auto-save on files, and also create backup files ending with *~*. You can mark such files using the *~* command.

Regex

You can use *%d* to select files based on a regular expression (regex) to mark for deletion. To simply mark files based on regex, you can use the *%m* shortcut. To rename the marked files, you can use *%R*.

Find

You can search for files matching a pattern using the *M-x*

find-name-dired command. Suppose you wish to find all the *.txt* files in our original */tmp/test* directory, you can use *M-x find-name-dired* in the Dired buffer. It will prompt you in the minibuffer with the following message ‘Find-name (directory): */tmp/test*’. After you press the return key, it will ask for the regex with the message ‘Find-name (filename wildcard):’. If you input **.txt*, it will return the following contents:

```
/tmp/test/:
find . \( -name '*.txt' \) -ls
6826601 4 -rw-rw-r-- 1 shakthi shakthi 29 Jul 5
09:46 date.txt
6826616 64 -rw-rw-r-- 1 shakthi shakthi 63050 Jul 5
09:46 kernel/dmesg.txt
6826602 4 -rw-rw-r-- 1 shakthi shakthi 270 Jul 5
09:46 locale.txt
```

find finished at Sun Jul 5 10:27:02

You can also find files based on regex patterns that exist in the file contents using *M-x find-grep-dired*. Suppose you wish to find the files that have the text ‘*eth*’ in them, you can use *M-x find-grep-dired*, which will prompt you in the minibuffer with the message ‘Find-grep (directory): */tmp/test*’. After you press the return key, it will prompt you for the regex with the message ‘Find-grep (grep regexp):’, where you can input ‘*eth*’ and this will return the following results:

```
/tmp/test/:
find . \( -type f -exec grep -q -e eth {} \) -ls
6826605 4 -rw-rw-r-- 1 shakthi shakthi 1620 Jul 5
09:46 network/ifconfig.output
6826616 64 -rw-rw-r-- 1 shakthi shakthi 63050 Jul 5
09:46 kernel/dmesg.txt
```

find finished at Sun Jul 5 10:31:27

You can also execute a *find* operation on marked files using *M-x find-dired*.

Help

To open the *Help* menu for Dired, you can use the *h* shortcut key. To see the Dired log messages, you can press the *? key*.

You may refer to a quick reference card at <https://www.gnu.org/software/emacs/refcards/pdf/dired-ref.pdf> and try out more Dired commands. 

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